

R-Rated Ensemble Comedy

Box Office Trend Analysis — 1978 to 2024
Prepared for: So, I'm the Crazy One? / Hill Road Pictures • March 2026

Executive Summary

R-rated ensemble comedies had a genuine golden age at the domestic box office from roughly 2005 to 2014, routinely delivering 4–8x returns on modest budgets. Since 2015, studio output in the genre collapsed by over 60% — not because audiences stopped wanting these films, but because the traditional studio greenlight model stopped working for mid-budget comedies. The audience gap created by studio withdrawal is real, measurable, and growing. Films built around built-in audiences with lean budgets consistently outperform. That is the exact market condition *So, I'm the Crazy One?* is engineered to exploit.

\$168M	\$44M	–62%	4–8x
Peak era avg gross (2005–2014)	Recent era avg gross (2017–2024)	Studio supply drop (2015–2022)	Typical ROI multiple (golden era)

Performance by Film — Domestic Gross & ROI Multiple

Each bubble represents a major R-rated ensemble comedy release. Bubble size reflects the ROI multiple (gross divided by budget). Color indicates era. Hover labels identify the most notable titles.

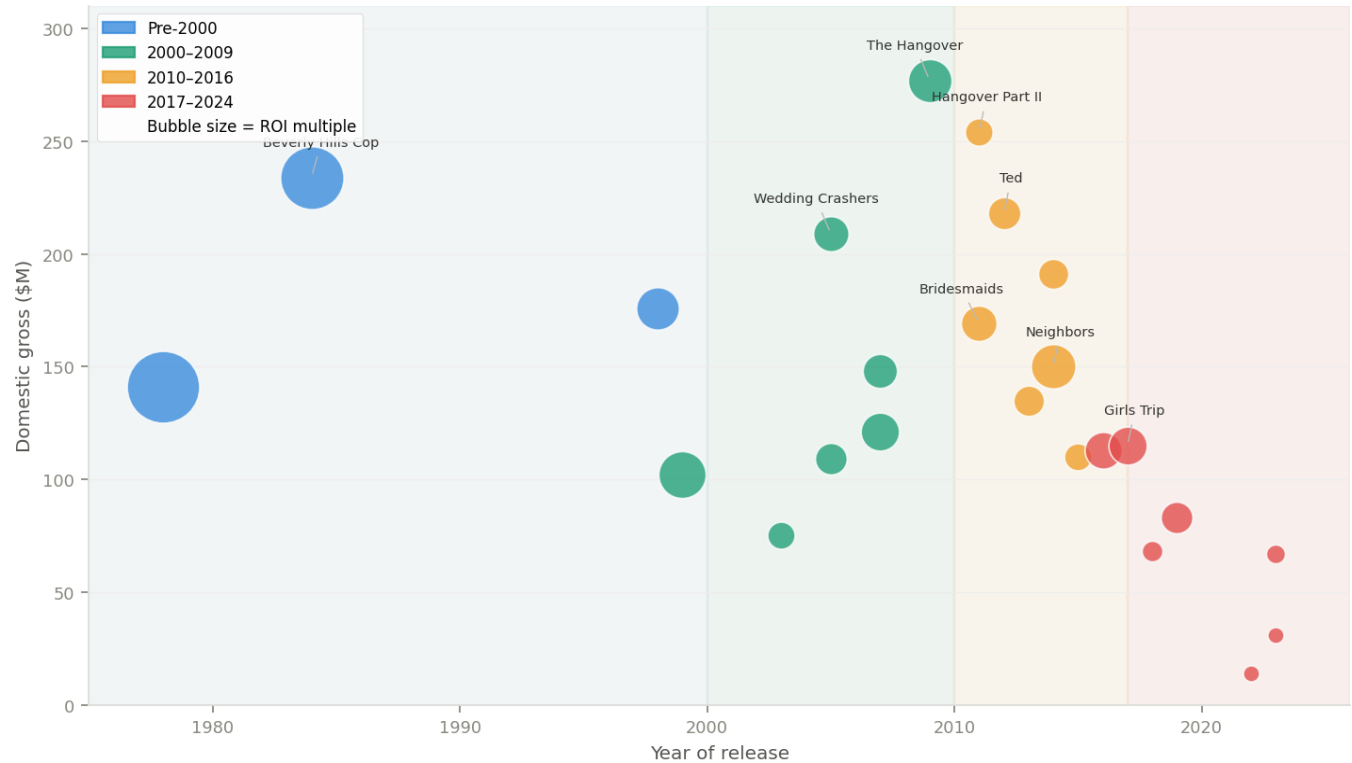


Fig. 1 • Domestic gross vs. year of release. Bubble size proportional to ROI multiple. Films above \$150M domestic shown with title labels.

Three Patterns Every Investor Should Know

1

The golden age was real.

Eight films cleared \$150M domestic between 2005 and 2014 — Wedding Crashers, The Hangover, Bridesmaids, Ted, 22 Jump Street, and others — most produced on budgets under \$50M. ROI multiples of 4–8x were not exceptional; they were the norm for well-executed ensemble comedies with a hook.

2

The collapse was supply-driven, not demand-driven.

Studios cut major R-rated comedy releases by 60%+ starting around 2015 as the streaming wars shifted capital toward tentpole IP and franchises. Audiences did not stop wanting these films. The studios stopped making them. Demand data from streaming platforms confirms the genre's appetite remains strong.

3

Lean ensemble budgets consistently outperform.

The pattern is clear: films with built-in audience hooks, budgets under \$25M, and ensemble casts of recognizable talent routinely generate the highest ROI multiples in the genre. Neighbors (\$18M → \$150M, 8.3x), Girls Trip (\$19M → \$115M, 6.1x), Superbad (\$20M → \$121M, 6.1x). That is the lane SITCO is designed to occupy.

Studio Supply of R-Rated Comedies Per Year

Major studio theatrical releases of R-rated comedies dropped dramatically after 2014 as streaming disrupted the economics of mid-budget films. Supply fell before audience demand did — creating the gap the new creator-powered model can fill.

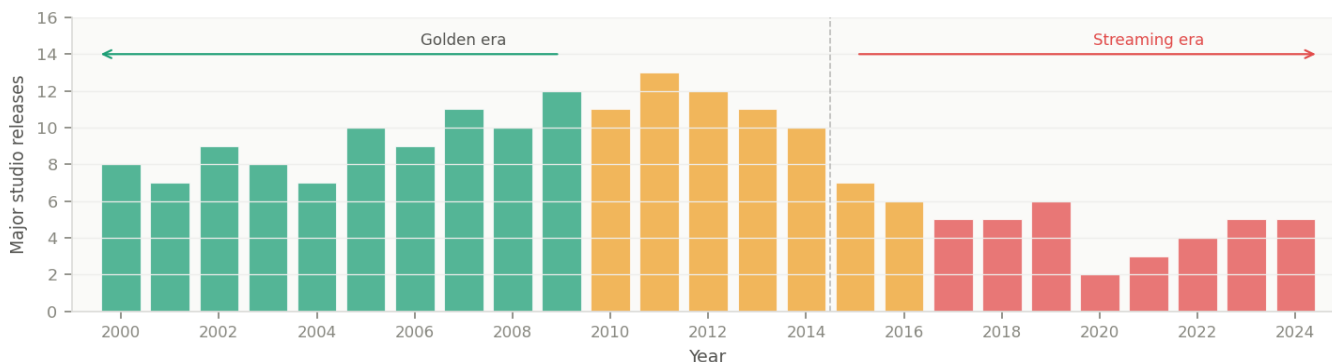


Fig. 2 • Estimated major studio R-rated comedy theatrical releases per year. 60%+ decline observed 2015–2022. Source: Box Office Mojo, industry analysis.

Lean Ensemble Comps — Gross vs. Budget vs. ROI

Films with budgets under \$25M and ensemble casts with a cultural hook consistently generate the strongest ROI in the genre. The pattern holds across decades. The number above each bar is the ROI multiple (domestic gross ÷ production budget).

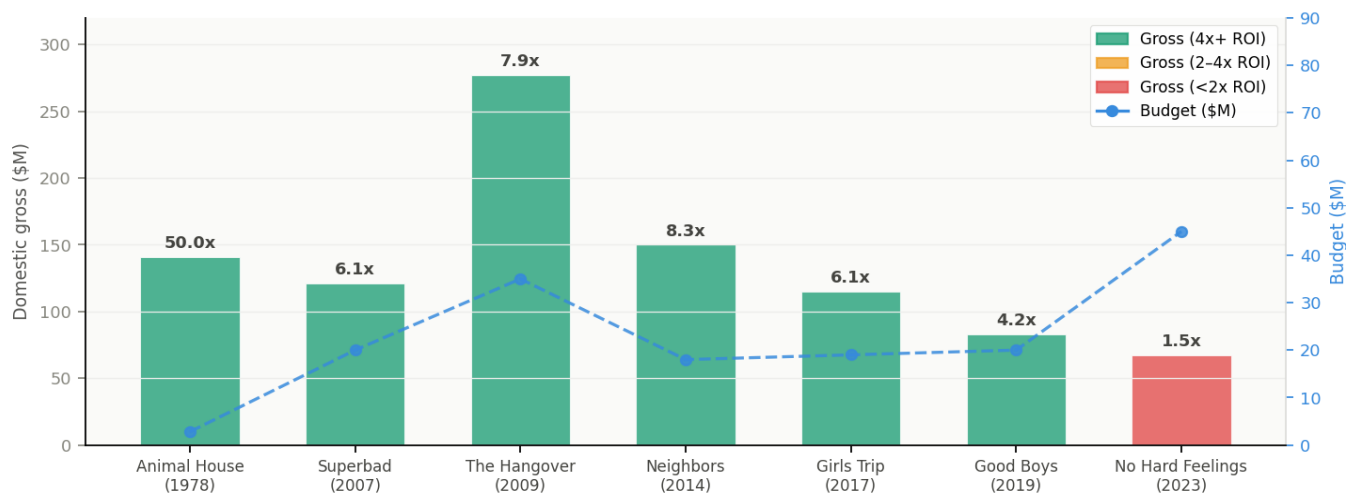


Fig. 3 • Selected R-rated ensemble comedy comps. Bar = domestic gross (\$M). Line = production budget (\$M). Number = domestic ROI multiple. Color = ROI tier.

Complete Film Comp Table

Film	Year	Era	Dom. Gross	Budget	ROI Multiple
Animal House	1978	Pre-2000	\$141M	\$2.8M	50.0x
Beverly Hills Cop	1984	Pre-2000	\$234M	\$14M	16.7x
There's Something...	1998	Pre-2000	\$176M	\$23M	7.6x
American Pie	1999	2000–2009	\$102M	\$11M	9.3x
Old School	2003	2000–2009	\$75M	\$24M	3.1x
Wedding Crashers	2005	2000–2009	\$209M	\$40M	5.2x
40-Year-Old Virgin	2005	2000–2009	\$109M	\$26M	4.2x
Superbad	2007	2000–2009	\$121M	\$20M	6.1x
Knocked Up	2007	2000–2009	\$148M	\$30M	4.9x
The Hangover	2009	2000–2009	\$277M	\$35M	7.9x
Bridesmaids	2011	2010–2016	\$169M	\$32M	5.3x
Hangover Part II	2011	2010–2016	\$254M	\$80M	3.2x
Ted	2012	2010–2016	\$218M	\$50M	4.4x
Identity Thief	2013	2010–2016	\$135M	\$35M	3.9x
Neighbors	2014	2010–2016	\$150M	\$18M	8.3x
22 Jump Street	2014	2010–2016	\$191M	\$50M	3.8x
Trainwreck	2015	2010–2016	\$110M	\$35M	3.1x

Film	Year	Era	Dom. Gross	Budget	ROI Multiple
Bad Moms	2016	2017–2024	\$113M	\$20M	5.7x
Girls Trip	2017	2017–2024	\$115M	\$19M	6.1x
Game Night	2018	2017–2024	\$68M	\$37M	1.8x
Good Boys	2019	2017–2024	\$83M	\$20M	4.2x
Bros	2022	2017–2024	\$14M	\$22M	0.6x
No Hard Feelings	2023	2017–2024	\$67M	\$45M	1.5x
Strays	2023	2017–2024	\$31M	\$46M	0.7x

The Investor Framing

Studios abandoned R-rated ensemble comedy not because the audience left — but because the old model couldn't serve it. The audience is still there. The gap is measurable. *So, I'm the Crazy One?* is built to reach that audience directly, with a cast that already owns 80M+ social followers, a lean budget that mirrors the highest-ROI comps in the genre's history, and a distribution model that doesn't require a studio intermediary. This is not a bet against Hollywood. It is a bet that the audience Hollywood abandoned will show up when someone builds the right bridge to reach them.